Language Access and City Service in Los Angeles

Limited-English neighborhoods report more, and everyday requests close just as fast

How much people report

24%+ vs up to 4% limited-English households, adjusted for income, renters, housing age and density. Raw gap: +24%.

More 311 requests per household (adjusted)

+38%

How fast requests close

Median days, up to 4% vs 24%+ limited-English households. Raw; adjusted, no clear gap.

Everyday requests (days)

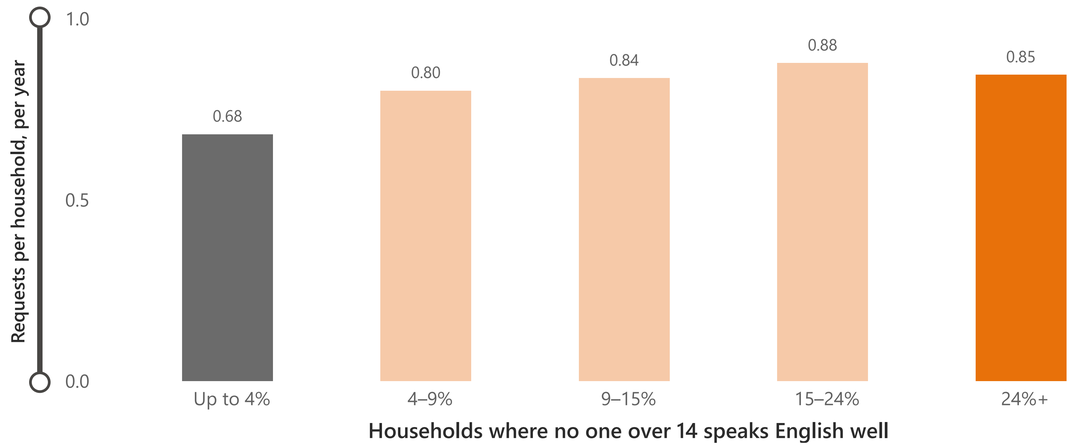
2.3 vs 2.1

Slow services (days)

68 vs 88

Limited-English areas report more, not fewer

Resident 311 requests per household per year, by share of limited-English households (raw rates)



Everyday requests close in about 2 days everywhere

Median days to close. Streetlights and encampments are slow in every area

request_type	Up to 4%	4–9%	9–15%	15–24%	24%+
Bulky Items	2.24	2.24	2.28	2.15	2.11
Electronic Waste	2.24	2.17	2.14	2.00	1.96
Graffiti Removal	2.05	1.72	1.09	1.09	1.70
Homeless Encampment	45.29	44.26	46.99	48.83	58.35
Illegal Dumping Pickup	3.70	3.65	3.71	3.22	2.98
Metal/Household Appliances	2.23	2.22	2.21	2.09	2.05
Multiple Streetlight Issue	131.33	134.88	184.80	178.58	218.44
Single Streetlight Issue	130.78	135.96	162.91	155.23	182.56

What this means

1. Language is not what separates neighborhoods in 311 service. Limited-English areas report more per household, and everyday requests close in about the same time.
2. Streetlights and encampments take months to close in every kind of neighborhood. Look at those first.
3. Read with care: these areas also have lower incomes ($52K vs $118K median) and more renters (83% vs 51% of households). This is a pattern, not proof of cause, and a null result is not proof of fair treatment.
4. What we'd do: support the mobile app (42% of requests in the highest group vs 31% in the lowest), check the 10 tracts that file far fewer requests than their housing predicts, and record the language of each 311 contact.

Limited-English household: no one aged 14 or older speaks English "very well." Sources: MyLA311 requests 2022-2024; Census ACS 2019-2023; City of Los Angeles tracts with 100+ households. Groups are fifths of tracts by limited-English share. Median days are Kaplan-Meier estimates that count open requests as still waiting. Details in the project notebooks.